

FieldFlow

Governance Information Requirements

Governance Information Requirements

Data & information needs for board and senior management in day-to-day NGO operations

Companion to [Technical.md](#) and [Whitepaper.md](#)

Purpose

This document defines the minimum set of data, reports, dashboards, and alerts that the **board** and **senior management** of an NGO using FieldFlow need to see — and at what cadence — to discharge their fiduciary, strategic, and operational responsibilities.

It is written from two angles simultaneously:

- **What** the platform must surface (a product spec)
- **Who** needs to see it, **when**, and **why** (a governance spec)

Use it to:

1. Configure FieldFlow dashboards and report schedules for a new NGO.
2. Brief a new board member or director on what they should be looking at.
3. Audit whether the current platform setup meets governance needs.

1. Stakeholder map

Role	Decision horizon	Primary concern
Board of Trustees	Quarterly · annual	Mission, compliance, financial health, reputational risk
Executive Director / CEO	Weekly · monthly	Program delivery, donor relations, team health, cash
Program Director	Daily · weekly	Project delivery vs. plan, exception management
Finance Controller	Daily · monthly	Cash position, FCRA compliance, audit-readiness
MEAL Lead	Weekly · quarterly	Data quality, indicator integrity, impact attribution
HR Lead	Weekly	Attrition, attendance, payroll compliance
Field Manager	Daily	Today's plan, today's exceptions, tomorrow's deployment

This document covers the top 5 rows. Field-manager day-to-day is covered in [Walkthrough.md](#).

2. Board of Trustees — quarterly information pack

The board meets quarterly. They are unpaid, time-constrained, and legally accountable. Their information needs must be **summarised, comparative, and exception-driven** — never raw operational data.

2.1 Required quarterly report (single PDF, ≤12 pages)

#	Section	What it shows	FieldFlow source
1	Mission delivery scorecard	One-page table: every active project, % of annual target reached, traffic-light status	<code>action_plans × project_deliverables</code> aggregate
2	Beneficiaries served	Cumulative unique beneficiaries this FY, broken down by gender/age/caste/disability	<code>daily_reports.custom_data</code> aggregates
3	Geographic footprint	Map of villages reached + new villages this quarter	<code>daily_reports.location</code> distinct
4	Financial summary	Cash on hand, burn rate, donor receivables, FCRA balance	External (finance team to supply)
5	Grant pipeline	Active grants, expiring grants, prospects in pipeline	External
6	Compliance heatmap	FCRA, ITR, 12A/80G, state society returns — green/amber/red	External + audit log
7	Risk register	Top 5 risks with severity, owner, mitigation status	Manual entry by ED, surfaced in FieldFlow
8	People	Headcount, attrition rate, hires, exits, gender ratio	<code>users</code> table
9	Significant events	Major incidents, audits, media coverage, donor visits	Audit log + ED narrative
10	Strategic decisions needed	1–3 issues requiring board approval	Manual — ED prepared

2.2 Required board KPIs (4-quarter trend visible at every meeting)

KPI	Definition	Target
Mission scorecard average	Mean % of annual targets reached across all projects	≥ Expected by date
Beneficiaries served (YoY)	Unique beneficiaries this quarter vs. same quarter last year	+10% YoY
Cost per beneficiary	Total program spend ÷ unique beneficiaries	Stable or declining
Donor retention	Returning donors as % of last year's donor base	≥80%

KPI	Definition	Target
Months of operating runway	$(\text{Cash} + \text{receivables}) \div \text{monthly burn}$	≥ 6 months
Compliance index	% of compliance items in "green" status	100%
Voluntary attrition	Staff exits initiated by employee	<15% annualised
Audit observations	Internal + statutory + donor audit findings	0 critical

2.3 Off-cycle alerts to board chair

The platform should immediately alert the board chair (email + WhatsApp) when:

- Cash runway drops below 3 months
- A FCRA, ITR, or society return goes overdue
- A donor formally raises a grievance
- A media-coverage event (positive or negative) is flagged
- A safeguarding/POSH incident is reported
- Any single payment > ₹5 lakh is initiated

These are exceptions, not routine reports. The chair should receive ≤ 6 of these per year in a well-run NGO.

3. Executive Director — weekly + monthly view

The ED needs **real-time visibility** without being buried in detail. The platform should give the ED a single landing page that loads in under 2 seconds and answers: *"What needs my attention today?"*

3.1 Required daily landing dashboard

Top strip — at-a-glance numbers:

- Reports submitted today / yesterday / 7-day rolling
- Active WhatsApp conversations
- Field staff online today
- Beneficiaries reached this week
- Cash position (read-only from finance system)

Middle — needs attention (max 7 items):

- Activity cells flagged behind schedule
- Field staff who haven't reported in 5+ days
- Unanswered donor queries >48h
- Pending approvals (leave, advances, vendor payments)

- WhatsApp conversations escalated to human handoff
- Dead-letter queue entries
- Open safeguarding/grievance cases

Bottom — this week's calendar:

- Donor commitments due
- Board / advisor calls
- Field visits planned
- Statutory filings due

3.2 Required weekly summary (delivered Monday 8am, single email)

- One-paragraph narrative: where we made progress, where we slipped, what changed
- Top 3 wins (auto-extracted from daily_reports with positive sentiment)
- Top 3 concerns (auto-extracted from needs-attention queue)
- Last week's beneficiary numbers
- This week's calendar
- Action items from last board meeting — status update

3.3 Required monthly close package (delivered first working day)

- Action Plan status per project (annual % achieved, traffic light)
- Beneficiary count for the month
- Cost-per-output for the month (where measurable)
- Field-staff time-allocation breakdown
- WhatsApp engagement metrics (sessions, completion rate, handoff rate)
- Audit log highlights — anything unusual

4. Program Director — daily + weekly view

The program director runs delivery. Their information needs are **operational, granular, and exception-driven**.

4.1 Required daily operations dashboard

Panel	Content
Today's field plan	Per worker: where they're going, what activities planned
Yesterday's reports	Submitted vs. expected. Workers who didn't report flagged.

Panel	Content
Action plan exceptions	Cells where actual is <50% of expected-by-now
Inbox	Field staff messages requiring program-director response
Approvals queue	Leave, advances, vendor payments awaiting their sign-off
Travel / logistics	Vehicles deployed, fuel logs, accommodation bookings

4.2 Required weekly view (delivered Friday afternoon)

- Per-project, per-location, per-activity status with last-7-days delta
- Top 10 underperforming cells with assigned owner
- Top 5 outperforming cells (replicate the success pattern)
- Staff productivity: reports per staff-day, average response latency
- Quality flags: reports flagged by AI as anomalous (numbers don't reconcile, location mismatch, etc.)

4.3 Required monthly view (delivered first working day)

- Full action plan rollup (downloadable Excel matches the donor format)
- Per-project narrative auto-drafted from daily_reports — for ED review then donor submission
- MEAL data quality score
- Field staff individual scorecards (for HR + performance review feed)

4.4 Real-time alerts to program director

- Field worker missed 3 consecutive daily reports
- An Action Plan cell shifts from amber to red
- A beneficiary survey response triggers a "grievance" intent in the WA NLU
- A donor-funded activity falls below 70% of monthly target with <5 working days left in month

5. Finance Controller — daily + monthly view

Finance has the **highest data-integrity bar** and the **strictest compliance burden**. Even though FieldFlow is not a finance system, governance information passes through it: who approved what, when, with what supporting evidence.

5.1 Required daily view

- Pending payment approvals
- Advances outstanding to field staff (with aging)
- Vendor invoices received via WhatsApp/email — awaiting matching
- FCRA bank balance vs. local bank balance (separation required by law)

- Reimbursement queue

5.2 Required monthly view

- Project-level burn vs. budget
- Grant-level fund utilisation
- Donor-restricted vs. unrestricted balances
- Statutory dues (TDS, PF, ESI, professional tax)
- Open audit findings + status

5.3 Compliance dashboard (always-on)

A traffic-light board for the following, with last-checked date:

Item	Frequency	Owner
FCRA quarterly return	Quarterly	Finance
FCRA annual return (FC-4)	Annual (Dec 31)	Finance
ITR-7	Annual (Oct 31)	Finance
Form 10B	Annual	Finance
State Society Annual Return	Annual	Compliance
GST returns (if applicable)	Monthly	Finance
PF / ESI returns	Monthly	HR
TDS returns	Quarterly	Finance
12A / 80G validity	Periodic	Finance
FCRA registration renewal	5-year	Finance
POSH committee constitution	Annual	HR
Internal audit	Half-yearly	Audit committee
Statutory audit	Annual	Audit committee
Donor audit reports	Per donor	Finance

5.4 Audit-readiness on demand

The platform must support producing the following on 24-hour notice for any external audit:

- All daily_reports for a date range + linked attachments
- All audit_log entries for a user / date range
- All wa_messages with a beneficiary for a date range
- All donor reports generated with timestamps and authors
- Original raw data behind any aggregate number in any donor report

6. MEAL Lead — weekly + quarterly view

MEAL owns indicator integrity. Their needs are about **data quality** and **causal attribution**, not just totals.

6.1 Required weekly view

- Indicator-level data freshness (how stale is each cell's underlying data)
- Anomaly report: numbers that fail sanity checks (e.g., beneficiaries today > population)
- Disaggregation completeness: % of reports where gender/age/caste fields are filled
- Voice-message transcription quality (when manual review flags transcript as wrong)
- Photo/attachment evidence rate (% of activities with supporting evidence)

6.2 Required quarterly view

- Per-indicator: planned vs. achieved with 95% confidence interval
- Theory-of-change tree with current evidence strength per link
- Outlier analysis: villages/activities deviating from norm
- Sample verification: 5% random sample of reports flagged for independent field verification
- Cross-source reconciliation: Action Plan totals vs. WhatsApp survey responses vs. donor reports

6.3 Annual view (for impact report)

- Cohort analysis (beneficiaries who entered Year 1 — where are they in Year 3?)
 - Outcome vs. output ratios
 - Cost-per-outcome
 - Counterfactual narrative (what would have happened without the intervention)
-

7. HR Lead — weekly view

HR's information needs touch FieldFlow because **field staff identity, role, and activity** live there.

7.1 Required weekly view

- Attendance summary (derived from daily_reports submission days)
- Workers with zero submissions in last 5 days
- Anomalous activity patterns (e.g., reports submitted from outside designated area)
- Productivity per staff (reports/day, beneficiaries reached)
- Leave applications pending
- Birthdays + anniversaries this week
- Open grievances / POSH complaints

7.2 Required monthly view

- Headcount by role / project / location
- Joiners / leavers
- Voluntary vs. involuntary exits
- Gender ratio, social-category ratio
- Average tenure
- Training completion rates

7.3 Annual view

- Attrition rate
 - Promotion velocity
 - Compensation distribution by role
 - Diversity scorecard
-

8. Cross-cutting requirements

These apply to every dashboard and report regardless of role.

8.1 Audit trail

Every numeric figure shown in any report must be drillable to its source: which daily_report, which staff member, which date, which beneficiary. No "magic numbers" allowed.

8.2 Period comparisons

Every metric should show a comparison: same period last year, last quarter, last month. A number without a comparison is decoration, not information.

8.3 Exception-first

Dashboards must surface exceptions before averages. A 95% on-track average is uninformative if there's one 30% outlier hidden inside it.

8.4 Mobile-readable

Board members and the ED read on phones at 6am and 11pm. Every dashboard must render legibly at 380px width.

8.5 Export-friendly

Every view must export to Excel/PDF in one click. Information that lives only inside the platform is information that doesn't get used in meetings.

8.6 Role-segregated access

A field worker must not see donor financials. A donor portal user must not see HR data. RBAC is enforced server-side, not just hidden in the UI. Currently: `superadmin > admin > manager > employee` with per-tab gating.

8.7 Language

Dashboards in English by default. Reports configurable in Hindi + 4 regional languages. WhatsApp interactions auto-detect.

8.8 Offline-tolerance

Field reports must queue and re-sync if connectivity drops. Already supported via WhatsApp's own delivery retry.

9. What the platform must NOT do

Equally important — to avoid scope creep and false confidence:

- **It does not replace a finance system.** Tally, Zoho Books, QuickBooks remain authoritative for ledgers. FieldFlow consumes summary figures.
- **It does not replace a payroll system.** Payroll computation, statutory deductions, and bank disbursement stay in the dedicated tool.
- **It does not authorise payments.** Approvals are recorded; the actual fund movement happens in the bank's portal.
- **It does not make legal compliance decisions.** It flags due dates and tracks status; a qualified CA or company secretary signs.
- **It does not replace human judgement in safeguarding.** It captures incident reports and routes them to the designated committee; investigation is human.
- **It does not generate fake data.** AI assists with extraction and narrative drafting, never with creating beneficiaries or activities that didn't happen.

10. Implementation checklist for a new NGO

When onboarding a new NGO to FieldFlow, ensure the following before the first board meeting:

- ☐ Org created with correct legal name, FCRA number, society registration
- ☐ All current trustees added with `superadmin` role
- ☐ Executive Director added with `admin` role

- ☐ Program Director(s) added with admin role
- ☐ All field staff added with employee role and correct project assignments
- ☐ Active projects added with annual targets and donor mapping
- ☐ Action Plan uploaded (Excel) for current FY
- ☐ WhatsApp Business number configured + webhook verified
- ☐ At least one welcome flow published
- ☐ Compliance calendar entries created with owners assigned
- ☐ Board email distribution list configured for alerts
- ☐ First weekly summary email scheduled (test delivery before the first Monday)
- ☐ First quarterly board report draft generated (test the format with the chair)
- ☐ Audit log retention confirmed at 365 days
- ☐ Data export procedure documented and tested
- ☐ Disaster-recovery contact (who calls Anthropic / Google support) identified

11. Governance maturity model

A scoring framework to assess where the NGO is on its data-governance journey.

Level	Description
L0 — Manual	Excel + paper. Board sees data 30+ days late.
L1 — Digitised	Forms exist. Data is captured but reports are still hand-built.
L2 — Integrated	One source of truth. Standard reports generated automatically.
L3 — Real-time	Dashboards live. Board can self-serve current state any time.
L4 — Predictive	AI flags risks before they materialise. Anomaly detection on indicators.
L5 — Closed-loop	Field input → MEAL → donor reports → strategy → field input, all flowing.

FieldFlow is designed to take an NGO from L0/L1 to L3 within 3 months and to L4/L5 within 12 months.

12. Open questions for the board to decide

These are governance choices the platform exposes but cannot decide for you:

1. **Data retention.** Default is 180 days for WhatsApp messages, 365 for audit logs. Some donors require 7 years. Decide and configure.

2. **Beneficiary consent model.** Opt-in vs. legitimate-interest. The platform supports both; legal counsel should advise.
 3. **AI-generated content review threshold.** Should all AI-drafted donor reports be reviewed by a human, or just summarised totals? Default is full review.
 4. **Beneficiary data export rights.** Under DPDP, beneficiaries can request their data. Who handles those requests? What is the SLA?
 5. **Cross-NGO benchmarking.** If you join a peer benchmarking cohort, what data is shared? Aggregates only, or sample-level?
 6. **Whistleblower channel.** Currently routed to the ED. Some boards want it routed to the chair. Decide.
 7. **Photo / video consent.** Do you require explicit per-event consent before any beneficiary image is captured? Default is no but recommended yes for under-18.
 8. **Subscription approval authority.** Who can approve moving from free tier to paid? Default is ED + Finance Controller jointly.
-

This document should be reviewed at least annually by the board's governance committee and updated when material changes happen to the platform, the NGO's structure, or the regulatory environment.

Last updated: June 2026 · v1.0